how Édouard could fight back after the Weinführer had tainted all his wine. “You’ve done so much for us. If I can help—if you need anything—please ask.”

“Thank you, Léa.”

* * *

That night, Léa struggled to sleep. She didn’t know if it was because of the soreness in her limbs—she’d worked all day until it was no longer possible to see the grapes in the darkness—or if it was the conversation she’d overheard between the Weinführer and Édouard.

Next to her, Rose dozed peacefully. Léa didn’t want to disturb her sister, so rather than tossing and turning, she decided to go to the kitchen and drink a glass of water, hoping it would soothe her mind and help her return to sleep.

She slid out of bed, the cold floor shocking her bare feet as she tiptoed across the room. She went through the open door to the corridor and into the kitchen. After filling a glass from the ceramic pitcher of water on the counter, she drank the cool liquid. Moonlight shone through the window, casting an ivory teardrop on the counter. She looked out the window: a light burned in the *chai* on the other side of the courtyard. It had to be Édouard. But why was he working when he should be sleeping?

Leaning close to the window, she saw a single silhouette cross the light. By now, Léa was wide awake. Why was he being so secretive—hiding the Weinführer’s visit and now working in the middle of the night? She put the glass down, went to the main door, slipped on her boots and crossed the courtyard.

Entering the vaulted *chai*, she inhaled the heady smell of grape must. From the drops of liquid on the ground and the small wooden ladder in front of one of the cement vats, she realized Édouard had been checking the fermentation. Where was he?

Léa advanced farther. In the corner near the rear wall, where she’d earlier seen a desk and chair on top of an old carpet, the carpet was now rolled up and placed on the table along with the chair and pushed to the side, revealing a stone that had been lifted from the floor. She crept closer and saw a narrow wooden staircase leading to an underground hatch. Was